

"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It’s a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.

After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.

Remember your first journey? I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word ‘Fiat’ itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience ‘**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**’ The discovery of the Fiat’s symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.

Let Scotomaville guide you on your ‘Personal Everest,’ empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

August 10, 2023

Dirty Gas

AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; **“The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.”** He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He’s demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

■ BACKGROUND - WWDWWD

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know **“Why We Do What We Do.”** and are committed to exploring the unknown... to ‘Know Thyself’. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. ⁽¹⁾ Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents ⁽²⁾. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We’re further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. ⁽³⁾ ⁽⁴⁾

We’re hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. ⁽⁵⁾ The adage to ‘Know Thyself’ is no longer a luxury. It’s become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. ⁽⁶⁾

■ METHODS - IMPARTATION

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:

Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal ‘journey with purpose’. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:

The program is more than just watching; it’s engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:

The Scotomaville journey doesn’t end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program’s licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING

By climbing a ‘Personal Everest’ and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with **“unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way”** ⁽⁹⁾ you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one’s physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one’s beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST

A ‘Personal Everest’ is a journey with a purpose. **“But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began...”**

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager ⁽¹⁰⁾

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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- (1) <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/>
 - (2) <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/>
 - (3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript
 - (4) <https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/>
 - (5) <https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team>
 - (6) <https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked>
 - (7) <https://intelligentnetware.com>
 - (8) <https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations>
 - (9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray
 - (10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

01

PAGE 24

SCOTOMA

FROM BIRTH OUR BIOLOGY BETRAYS OUR AWARENESS. SEEING THE WORLD AS IT REALLY IS REQUIRES A SHIFT IN OUR BELIEFS. THIS EXERSIZE WILL DO IT.

“WHEN WE ARE NO LONGER ABLE TO CHANGE A SITUATION, WE ARE CHALLENGED TO CHANGE OURSELVES.”
HOLOCAUST SURVIVOR VIKTOR FRANKL

02

PAGE 30

**PATTERN
RECOGNITION**

OUR 20 WATT BRAIN IS WIRED TO CUT CORNERS AND JUMP TO CONCLUSIONS.

03

PAGE 38

MISPERCEPTION

THE SLEEVES ILLUSION DEMONSTRATES CHAPTERS 1 AND 2 AT THE SAME TIME. COMBINED WITH STORYTELLING IT IS A CONVINCING DISPLAY OF OUR VULNERABILITY.

04

PAGE 44

ABUNDANT SCARCITY

THE GLOBAL PANDEMIC EXPOSED MOST PEOPLE’S CORE BELIEFS INCLUDING PRICE GOUGING AND HORDING.

05

PAGE 52

ABUNDANT AWARENESS

AWARENESS COMES WITH A PENALTY. THE MORE YOU KNOW, THE MORE YOU KNOW WHAT YOU DON’T KNOW.

06

PAGE 62

HIEROGLYPHICS

STORYTELLING IS A SUPERPOWER. IT’S BEEN USED TO INDUCE FEAR AND COMPLIANCE FOR MILLENNIA. ITS EASY TO CREATE AN AMYGDALA HIJACKING.

07

PAGE 70

ONION PEELING

WDIDWID? WHY DO I DO WHAT I DO? MASTER THIS SKILL AND YOU’LL GET OUT OF SCOTOMAVILLE.

08

PAGE 78

FIXATION

WITH POWER COMES RESPONSIBILITY. LEARN TO THROTTLE YOUR ATTENTION AND FOCUS.

09

PAGE 86

EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY

CROSSING A GAPING CREVASSE IS EASIER THAN MASTERING AN EMOTIONAL VOCABULARY. TRUST ME ON THIS ONE.

10

PAGE 94

CREATING SILENCE

WHEN YOU CAN HEAR YOUR INNER VOICE THEN YOU CAN ESCAPE WALLED GARDENS.

11

PAGE 100

FEED YOUR GUT

YOU AND I ARE 90% MICROBE AND ONLY 10% HUMAN. THERE'S A COUP UNDERWAY. EXPOSE IT WITH A SIMPLE QUESTION - WHEN YOU LOOK DOWN - DO YOU SEE YOUR SHOES OR YOUR GUT?

12

PAGE 108

IT NEEDS WORK

WE MISS THE BEST OPPORTUNITIES FOR GROWTH BECAUSE OPPORTUNITY GOES AROUND LOOKING LIKE HARD WORK.

13

PAGE 114

STRENGTHS OFFENDER

WE WOUND OTHERS WITH OUR STRENGTHS - WHICH ARE OUR PERFECTED COPING MECHANISMS FOR EARLY WOUNDS.

14

PAGE 122

TRIANGULATION

NEVER GO-IT-ALONE. YOU NEED NO LESS THAN THREE FACETS TO HAVE CONFIDENCE AND GRIT TO SUMMIT YOUR PERSONAL EVEREST.

15

PAGE 132

CURVES

LIFE HAS CURVES. THEY ARE EVERYWHERE. LEARN TO RECOGNIZE AND LEVERAGE THEM FOR AWARENESS.

16

PAGE 144

SEGUE

A SMOOTH TRANSITION TO THE NEXT VOLUME WITH A SHOCKING EXAMPLE OF ONUS PROBANDI.

2.00

PAGE 160

PRELUDE

WE CAN LEARN BY OBSERVATION IN ORDER TO MIMIC. DANIEL JUMPS TO A CONCLUSION... SO YOU DON'T SO MUCH.

2.01

PAGE 170

PERSISTENCE

'KNOW THYSELF' IS NO LONGER A LUXURY - IT'S A FULL ON COMPETITION.

2.02

PAGE 180

PROCESS

LEARNING HOW TO LEARN WILL ACCELERATE SKILL AND LIFE MASTERY.



2.03

PAGE 192

EXPECTATIONS

UNMET EXPECTATIONS ARE WINDOWS TO OUR BELIEFS. YOU CAN GET A GRIP ON YOUR EMOTIONAL ROLLER COASTERS.

2.04

PAGE 202

PATIENCE

WAITING FOR OUTCOMES IS TOUGH. WHAT IF THE DELAY IS 'BREAD AND CIRCUSES'?

2.05

PAGE 214

PREPARATION

ACTING 'AS-IF', PIVOTING WITH MULTIPLE STRATEGIES, OVERCOMING CHALLENGES BY MENTAL PREPARATION.



2.06

PAGE 226

SETBACKS

DEVELOPING YOUR 'WHY' FOR MAINTAINING INDEPENDENCE BY TAKING PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY WILL SERVE YOU WELL.

2.07

PAGE 236

STRATEGY I

INCREMENTALLY BUILDING A STRONG STRATEGY WILL HELP, AS WILL PAYING ATTENTION TO LITTLE THINGS.

2.08

PAGE 248

STRATEGY II

DEVELOP A SOLID STRATEGY TO COPE, SHIFT, AND PIVOT WITH YOUR MISTAKES, ERRORS AND FAULTS.

2.09

PAGE 258

SUBTLETIES

LEARNING TO NOT JUST HEAR - BUT
TO REALLY LISTEN IS A GREATLY
UNDERVALUED SKILL.



2.10

PAGE 270

SQUALLS

HOW DO YOU HANDLE DECISION-MAKING DURING
A DELUGE, DOWNPOUR OR A SQUALL? WDYDWYD?

2.11

PAGE 284

SATISFACTION

UNDERSTANDING OUR INNATE
BIASES AND SHORTCUTS CAN
LEAD US TO FIND SATISFACTION
IN THE MIDST OF CHALLENGES.

2.12

PAGE 298

SELF-CARE

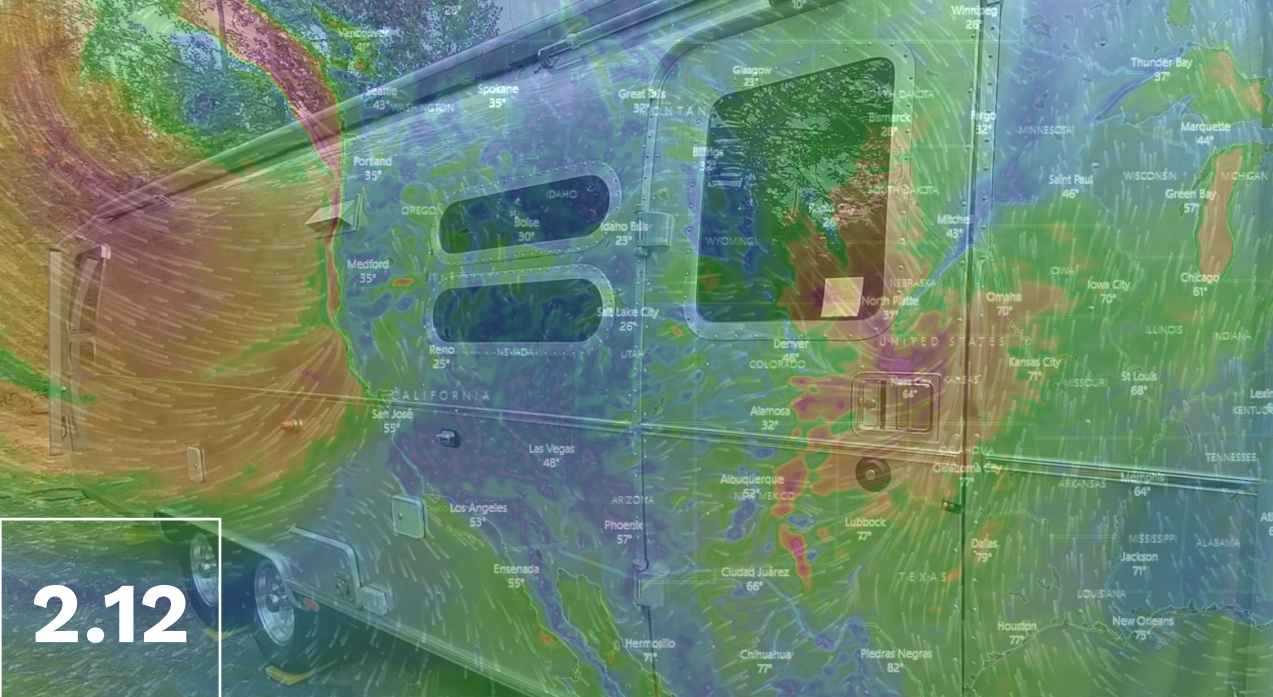
LIVING ‘THE DREAM’ COMES WITH
SURPRISES. UNWRAP YOUR PSYCHOLOGY
AND PHYSIOLOGY BY MIMICKING
WELLNESS AND LONGEVITY.

2.13

PAGE 318

STORIES

WE BEGIN LIFE WITH THE
STORY WE ARE HANDED.
FORTUNATELY, THAT’S NOT
THE END OF OUR TALE.



3.00

PAGE 336

QUICK START

EXPECTING OTHERS TO FOLLOW ISN'T FREEDOM OR WISE. PIVOTING AWAY FROM AN ERROR IS. THE REWARD IS IN GIVING YOUR FREEDOM TO OTHERS.

3.01

PAGE 342

FINDING WY

KNOWING HOW AND WHAT ARE IMPOTENT COMPARED TO KNOWING WHY.

3.02

PAGE 348

ROPED-UP

GOING IT ALONE IS CERTAIN CALAMITY, AS IS BEING ROPED-IN. DIFFERENTIATE.

3.03

PAGE 356

PACE & SEQUENCE

HOW MUCH, HOW OFTEN? THE PACE OF YOUR PRODUCTION SHOULD FOLLOW YOUR ACTUAL LEARNING BECASUE IT TAKES TIME TO GROW DENDRITES AND BELIEVE THE NEW YOU.

3.04

PAGE 364

MEASURING PROGRESS

WHAT'S THE MEASURE OF TRANSFORMATION AND SELF-MASTERY?

3.05

PAGE 372

INFLECTION

CHARACTER CHANGE HAPPENS ON A CURVE. AT SOME POINT THERE'S AN OBVIOUS PIVOT, AS WHEN THE OLD IS NO LONGER.

3.06

PAGE 390

MINYAN

A MENTAL ADVISORY BOARD FOR AI TO REFLECT, ASSESS, AND ADVISE. IMAGINE THE PEERS YOU WANT TO MIRROR AND GIFT THEM PURSUASIVE POWER.

3.07

PAGE 400

HEROES

EVERY HERO HAS A CHALLENGE. THE BEST OF US EXPRESS GENES AS A RESULT

3.08

PAGE 412

UNKNOWN

THERE'S A CURVE AHEAD. I'M CERTAIN OF THIS.

EXPEDITION PROCESS 2.02

THE PROCESS OF LEARNING IS MESSY. EXAMPLE:
WE ALL HAVE **SCATOMAS**, RIGHT? (*WRONG)



Welcome to a fabulous day in SCOTOMAVILLE.

Neil Degrasse Tyson excellently put it in a Master Class that I finished; 'it's not WHAT you think that matters. It's HOW you think'.

Critical thinking skills help us spot SCATOMAS by taking on our self-talk. So how do we develop that skill? That's the aim of this episode. It's essentially the learning PROCESS. I will use some examples of things I'm learning.

Patience First

First, we have to be patient with ourselves. We have to understand the bigger picture to get through the tricky parts of the journey.

The reason why I recommend mimicking - for you to do your own video series - is that you're going to edit your clips and notice, as I did, my nose hairs are turning silver. Really? Do I have to shave up into my nose? What a distraction. Now, I have to re-shoot this scene! Little things that

* A SCATOMA (NOT A SCOTOMA) IS A TUMOR-LIKE MASS OF FECES IN THE COLON!



ANGELINA 'LEARNING HOW TO LEARN'
BY PRACTICING SAIL TRIM W/O RIVER WATER

'IT'S NOT WHAT YOU THINK THAT MATTERS. IT'S HOW YOU THINK'

NEIL DEGRASSE TYSON

you weren't previously aware of start piling up. There's more and more... laugh with me.

Facets of Self-Mastery

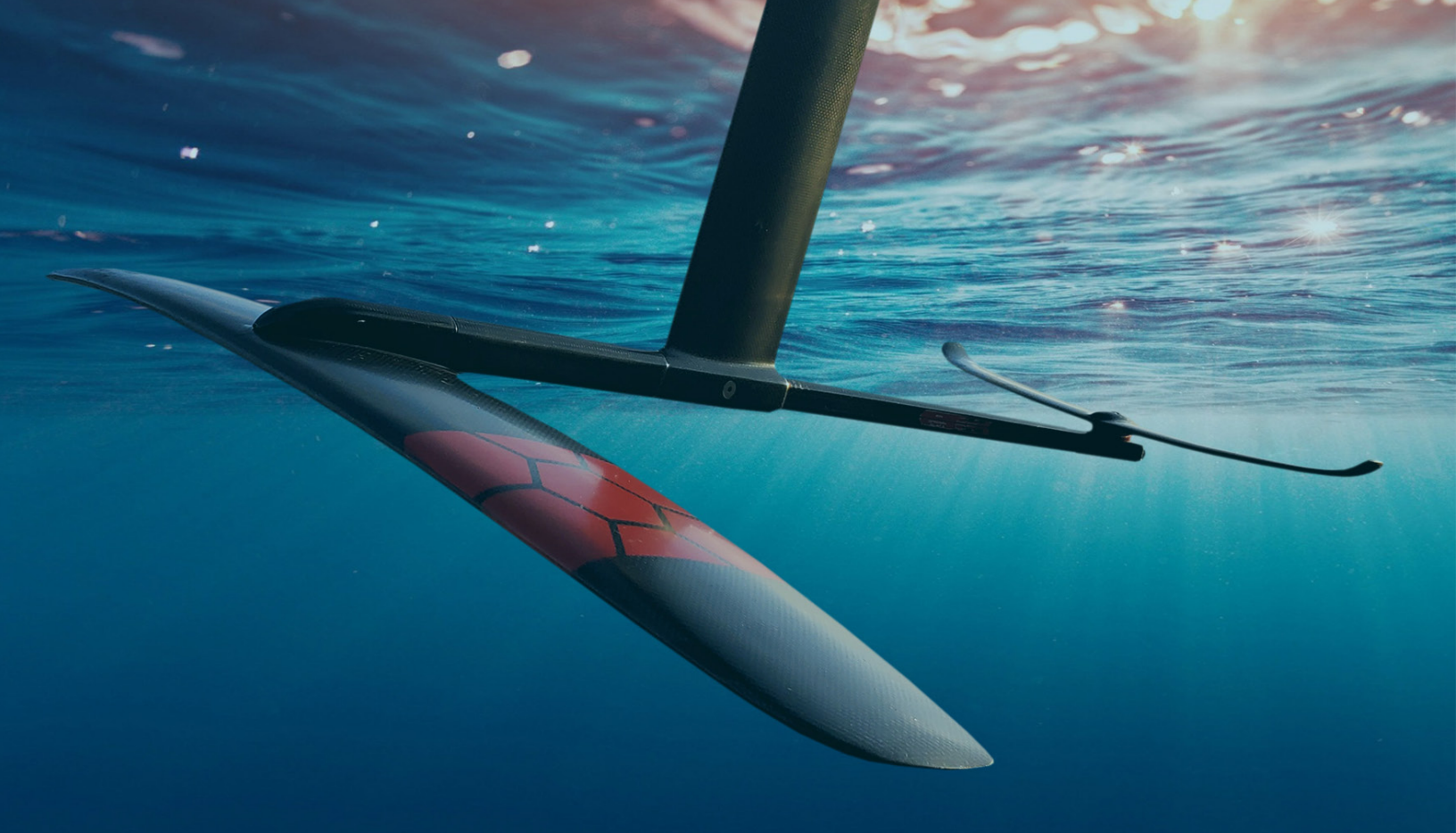
The facets are Awareness, Understanding, and Discipline. I now have a new discipline to master. Now I'm going to shave up into my nose! Three years later I'm plucking hair from my ears. What's next?

COLLABORATIVE LEARNING

Let's go to the launch site near the Hood River sandbar where we are wind-foiling, kite-surfing, kite-boarding, wing-foiling. It's a place where we spread our toys out and collaborate on the learning experience commiserating with each other's crashes but ultimately learning by mimicking. There's lots of learning going on. We're all willing to fail often and to fail forward. We get up and try again because we're not alone.

The learning we do on the water is similar to a journey of Self-mastery. Our outward expedition to master a sport is a mirror of the inner exploration to 'Know-Thyself'. Cool, right?

*We start by being **unconsciously incompetent** - that is - we're not aware of how bad we are. We don't see our scotomas.*



I'VE FALLEN MORE THAN MOST GUYS ON MY BEACH. I'M COMMITTED TO LEARNING AND WILL NOT FAIL UNLESS I CHOSE TO QUIT. THAT'S NOT GOING TO HAPPEN!

Next, we become **consciously incompetent**. We become aware of the power of the wind and how bad the conditions are for our skills. We learn that incremental progress and feedback are required.

The third stage is becoming **consciously competent** - that is - we're mastering the tools and techniques.

Ultimately we become **unconsciously competent** - being able to rig, launch and go where we want to go.

Four Stages

Unconsciously incompetent
Consciously incompetent
Consciously competent
Unconsciously competent

Daniel: "Garth, you tried wind foiling. I bet you went from **unconsciously incompetent to becoming consciously incompetent**. I feel for you because that's awkward."

Garth: "Yeah and my shin is proof! **Even though Daniel explained** to me to stay away from the foil I managed to kick it good and hard with both of my legs - **moving my awareness from unconscious to conscious**."

READ HOMO DEUS

Remember? The burden of proof is on the claimant not on the recipient! Two years ago I shot an Episode about Dataism and global challenges like **pandemics** and that we better be prepared.

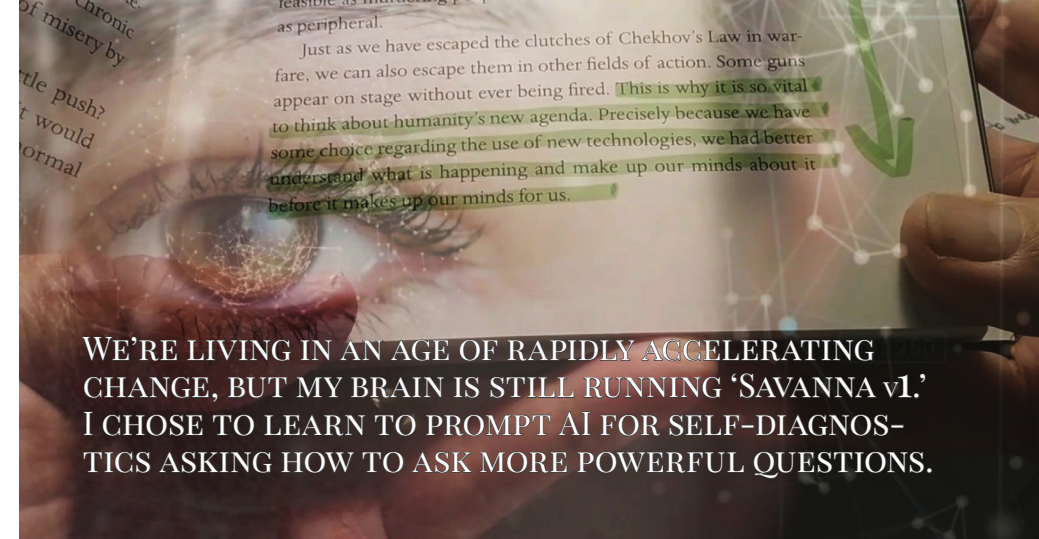
Reading from Yuval Harari.

"For the first time in history, more people die today from eating too much than from eating too little. More people die from old age than from infectious diseases and more people commit suicide than are killed by soldiers terrorists and criminals combined.

Up till now increasing human power relied mainly upon upgrading our external tools. In the future, it may rely more on upgrading the human body and mind or on merging directly with our tools.

This is why it's so vital to think about humanity's new agenda. Precisely because we have some choice regarding the use of new technologies. We had better understand what is happening and make up our minds about it before it makes up our minds for us."

read **Homo Deus!**



WE'RE LIVING IN AN AGE OF RAPIDLY ACCELERATING CHANGE, BUT MY BRAIN IS STILL RUNNING 'SAVANNA v1.' I CHOSE TO LEARN TO PROMPT AI FOR SELF-DIAGNOSTICS ASKING HOW TO ASK MORE POWERFUL QUESTIONS.

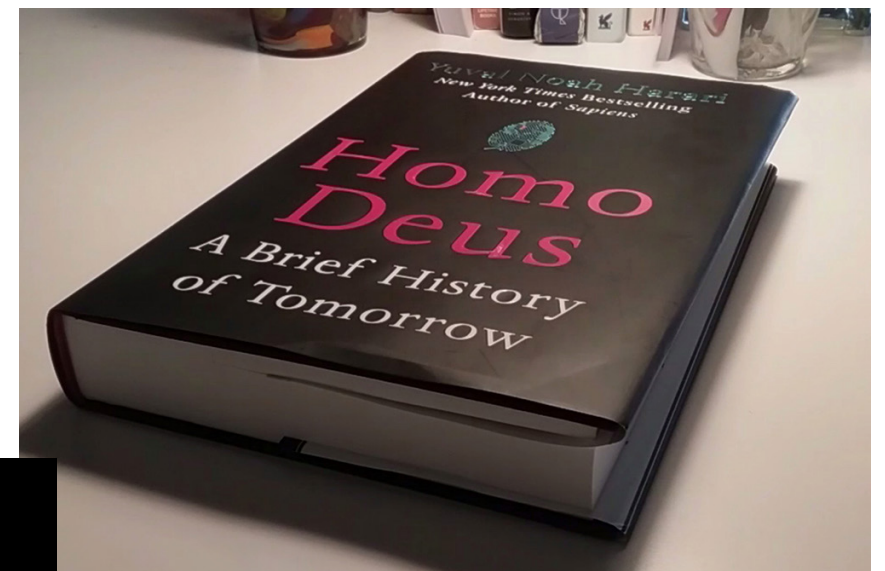


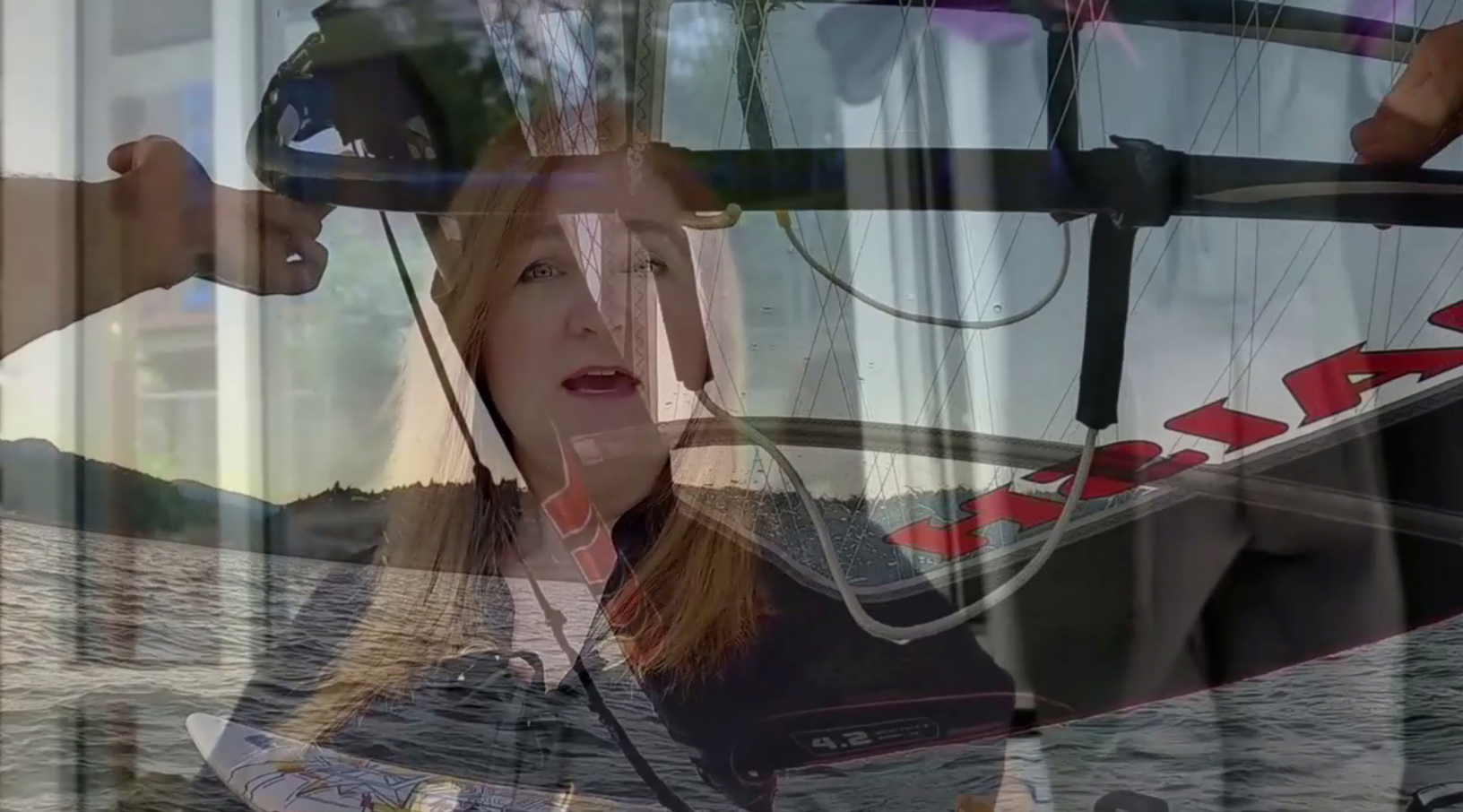
Certainly I'll assist, Daniel. Based on the exploration of self-mastery and personal development that you advocate, and drawing on the insights of experts in personal development, I'll rephrase the idea:

"We are experiencing an era marked by swift and relentless technological advancement, yet my mental framework remains grounded in its primitive 'Savanna v1' configuration. To navigate this dynamic landscape, I've decided

to engage with AI, seeking self-assessment and guidance on formulating more insightful and potent questions."

This reframing aligns with the pursuit of self-understanding and the utilization of AI as a tool to enhance human wisdom, reflecting the values you uphold. It also encapsulates the sentiment that, though technology is evolving, our intrinsic thinking processes may require deliberate effort to adapt.





LITTLE THINGS TOGETHER

Angelina: In my first journey on how to windsurf, there were several elements which played a role in the process. From having the proper equipment, to the order it is assembled.

Daniel had me holding the sail and practicing on land, learning how to control it with the wind's resistance and where my hands and feet positioning needed to be.

Once I carried the gear down to the water and got in, I had to learn how to climb onto the board, get to my feet, balance, and up-haul, then apply

what I had practiced on land beforehand, positioning my hands on the boom so that I could stand up and balance. I was constantly considering how all of these little bitty things work together.

I still didn't know what I didn't know yet following his lead; as someone who has done this work for a long time, I was grateful for what I achieved.

Authors Note:

For the third edition, I edited the previous page to include AI, demonstrating life-long learning, and how the youthful exploration of sport teaches us how to focus within on the journey of self-mastery.



DISCOVERING BLIND-SPOTS

Let me slow the pace of this Episode to help you absorb what I'm about to demonstrate - my process of discovering blind spots regarding my production pace.

Using the emotional word list, I match words to my emotions. I'm feeling frustrated. I have a degree of anger - a subtle contention with the work I'm doing. Okay, here's a fitting word: conflicted.

I've been working on this Episode for five weeks. It has 400 video clips. That's four times my usual number of clips for an Episode. This is because I have had to 'sleuth' out the actual message (Sherlock Holmes - to sleuth). This obstacle allowed me to discover a scotoma regarding my performance and self-esteem.

My top Clifton 'strength' is 'Achiever.' It's a coping mechanism that gives me value and meaning. My expectation of one Episode a week was established in Volume One. I am feeling a sense of shame and a degree of disappointment for falling behind an imaginary standard. I am conflicted between dopamine

and performance.

All of this is an emotional Gordian Knot - a habit I created from a 'rule' I unconsciously had set. It's a future-self neuro-transmitter addiction.

Your Personal Everest will fill with discoveries of scotomas. You shouldn't settle for an easy answer. Dig into emotional knots. Sleuth out the core onion layer. Challenge your assumptions and make incremental progress using modern assessment tools.

UNCONSCIOUSLY INCOMPETENT

I had intended to shoot a drone shot of my foiling footwork, but I forgot to bring the cable to connect my cell phone to the controller. The cable is sitting on my desk. I'm **consciously** incompetent.

At first, I created a rule to remind myself not to leave the cable. That was simply a mental short-cut to a real solution. Solutions are tough to find because you have to dig deep to determine the scotoma.

I reviewed a few video tutorials and learned of a handy storage space in the controller. Now I have a solution to

"con·sci·en·tious:
wishing to do
what is right,
especially to do
one's work or
duty well and
thoroughly "

avoid frustration when I forget my own rule. I made extra-effort to watch videos to discover a scotoma, and I can now drop the dumb rule about not forgetting the cord again. We find solutions after sleauthing the scotoma.

How about all that fancy footwork I wanted to record by drone? Useless. It turns out I've been practicing it wrong. I simply need to take a few small steps to jibe, not a giant leap. I discovered another scotoma by roping-up with Alex.

(P.S. Within a year, I conquered most jibes!)

"Solutions are found on the other side of scotomas.

You have to make extra efforts to sleuth them out."

AUTHORS NOTE: Alex foils for the love of flying. He didn't seek out a spotlight on his skills or insights or good will. He simply loves to fly. That's what we appreciate about him. His passion for learning is infectious.



“victory begins...”

“victory begins where the perseverance of others wanes”

Alex Laudon

Commercial Pilot & Windfoiling Ambassador

Daniel: “This is Alex Laudon. Alex tell me how long you’ve been riding.”

Alex: “It goes back to 1978 that started in France with the Windsurfer One design and teak booms and a 6.3 sail - so that’s 42 years ago I think.”

Daniel: “Tell us about this video... you foiled from this launch site to Stevenson, to Mosier and back. What in the world!”

Alex: “It’s a little sightseeing trip in the Gorge - it’s perfect.”

Daniel: “You made 145 jibes!”

Alex: “You counted?”

Daniel: “Yes. How long did it take you to get your jibes down on a foil?”

Alex: “I did my first foiling jibe the third time I went out on the hydrofoil.”

Daniel: “This is what we call unconsciously competent. Natural at it. What do you say for those of us that are constantly crashing and wanting to give up because we don’t think we have what it takes?”

Alex: “What do they say? The victory begins where the perseverance of others wanes... It’s the domain of experts in pretty much any field. A Master Chess player can look at a chessboard and within a few seconds know exactly what move to make. They recognize the scene and know where to go.





MOST OF US WILL GET BY WITH THE GEAR WE START WITH. THE TRICK IS TO UPGRADE WHEN BETTER STUFF IS AVAILABLE. MANY PEOPLE PREFER TO STAY WITH FAMILIAR RATHER THAN CHANGE FOR THE BETTER.

Alex: “Don’t quit. Keep trying. Never give up”.

Daniel: “Yesterday I had the privilege of you riding behind me - sort of spotting me a little. What are your comments about my riding after three years of working on my jibes?”

Alex: “... you had it down on reaches. You flew a stable flight. You had a few difficulties with the jibes, but I think the equipment is holding you back in your progress. Gear has evolved a lot in the last two years. Wings have become a lot more stable. We know what board shapes work, and when you have good equipment you can progress quickly.”

LISTENING IS A LEARNED SKILL

You’ll remember a top skill of Self-awareness from v1 is mindful listening. I took Alex’s suggestion and rode a larger foil as a demo. I discovered that I do have the skill-set for jibing - I just lack proper tools to gain experience with.

HINT: The mental tools from Volume One? Pick some of those. Try them out. Practice with them. The change will do you good.

Sticking with the familiar rather than restarting the learning process thwarts almost any good expedition or Personal Everest.

MY FOB STORY

Here’s a cognitive bias example: I jumped to a conclusion with a 20-watt brain. I didn’t want to dig for understanding because I’m busy. Yeah, short-cut habits cloak scotomas.

I have an electronic key fob and a key-less ignition in my truck. Anyone can open the doors if the fob is in the cab. I can’t take the fob on the water in my wetsuit, and I don’t want to leave it on the beach.

I’ve been sticking the fob in the bed of the truck near the tailgate. It lets me lock the doors, but not the tailgate. That’s been my half-wrong patch. I’ve asked other owners how they solved it. Nope. That’s the way it is, they say.

I finally dug around for a real solution. Ford designed the door entry pad so that if you press the last two buttons simultaneously, and the truck fully locks with your key inside.

Yeah - I found a solution by making extra effort to sleuth it out.

“When you catch yourself unwilling to consider something new... you’re getting close to a protected false-belief and a mental scotoma”

Alex said, “**Don’t quit. Keep trying. Never give up.**”

I’m saying that’s the hard work. The easy way is to create a mental rule, or to accept an excuse, or settle for a patch that someone or something recommends.

The hard work of self-mastery is seeing with new eyes. Cycling across America was easy compared to self-discovery of blind-spots. You may feel like there’s not an answer, or believe no one has solved it before. You and I might want to be lazy and accept the first offer — nay, nay. Climb higher. Ask more powerful questions.





WATCH



<https://youtu.be/5DCsRe0T9xQ>

DISCUSS



Share with other readers how you go about solving personal challenges.

SETTLING for an answer is far easier than seeking out a final solution. Finding solutions is far superior to simply swallowing answers. **Describe a transformative learning process of your own.**

Parable of the Novice Gardener

by Chat Generative Pre-trained Transformer (GPT)



Once, a wise old gardener embarked on a journey to cultivate a barren land. He was joined by a young novice eager to learn but impatient to see results.

The wise gardener told the novice, *“Planting a garden is like embarking on a journey of self-mastery. First, you must understand the soil, the climate, and the needs of each plant. You must be patient, for growth takes time.”*

The novice, eager to prove himself, planted his seeds hastily, without taking the time to understand the nuances of the land. The seeds struggled to sprout, and those that did were weak and withered.

The wise gardener, however, took his time. He studied the soil, the wind, and the sun’s path. He planted his seeds with care, understanding each one’s unique needs.

As weeks turned into months, the novice’s plot remained barren, while the wise gardener’s land flourished with life.

Frustrated and defeated, the novice turned to the wise gardener, “Why did my plants not grow? I did everything I could!”

The wise gardener replied, *“You were in haste and did not take the time to understand. You were unconsciously incompetent, not aware of how much you didn’t know. Had you been patient and willing to learn, you would have moved through the stages of competence, eventually reaching a point where growth would have come naturally.”*

The novice took these words to heart, realizing that the journey to mastery was not a race but a process of continuous learning, understanding, and adaptation.

He started again, this time with patience and a willingness to fail and learn. Over time, his garden too began to blossom.

The old gardener smiled, quoting Albert Einstein, *“It’s not that I’m so smart, it’s just that I stay with problems longer.”*



ChatGPT Reflection



This parable resonates with the key messages in the chapter text. *The journey from unconscious incompetence to unconscious competence is mirrored in the novice’s learning process. The wise gardener’s patience and understanding reflect the virtues of self-mastery and critical thinking emphasized in the chapter.*

The tale also aligns with principles from Marcus Aurelius’s Stoicism, focusing on the importance of understanding oneself and one’s surroundings, and the teachings of Carl Rogers, highlighting the need for patience, self-awareness, and personal growth.

The inclusion of this parable in the chapter would enrich the reader’s understanding of the concepts discussed, providing a metaphorical representation of the journey to self-mastery and learning that is at the heart of “Scotomaville.” It also underscores the importance of embracing failure, continuous learning, and collaboration, key aspects of your philosophy.



“Scotomaville” takes readers on an introspective journey into personal development. Through a seamless blend of philosophical dialogues, allegorical narratives, and psychological concepts, the book weaves an engaging exploration that appeals to both the mind and the heart. The author adeptly delves into themes such as perception, self-mastery, and the hero’s journey, showcasing a profound grasp of psychological processes and their influence on human behavior. **For those navigating the complexities of personal growth, the trilogy offers a transformative odyssey, illustrating that resilience and self-discovery are universal quests that resonate with individuals seeking to overcome inner challenges and doubts.**

This trilogy serves as **a reflection for military veterans and first responders**, echoing their sacrifices, camaraderie, and sense of purpose. The themes of adversity, seeking guidance, and embracing healing closely align with their experiences, providing a source of inspiration for those who have selflessly protected and served others.

For patriots and believers who hold their values dear, the trilogy presents character-driven narratives that mirror their dedication to higher principles. Exploring community, unity, and personal growth, the books align with their desire to positively contribute to society and reinforce the significance of collective well-being.

Fatherless individuals and young explorers identify with the trilogy’s portrayal of quests for identity and meaning. **The characters’ journeys from uncertainty to self-assuredness reflect the universal process of finding one’s place in the world, motivating young minds to navigate life’s puzzles with courage and determination.**

Moreover, **experts in fields from psychology and storytelling to stoic and biblical philosophy** will appreciate the trilogy’s profound concepts interwoven with relatable narratives. *The author’s mastery is evident in crafting a work that appeals to intellectual and emotional sensibilities alike.*

Throughout the trilogy, Daniel’s transformation serves as a relatable and inspiring narrative. His evolution from a curious seeker hindered by cognitive biases to a self-aware individual confronting inner doubts resonates deeply with readers.

In a world valuing personal growth, camaraderie, service, purpose, and self-discovery, **the Scotomaville Trilogy stands as proof of storytelling’s power to connect, inspire, and transform. Its pages offer lessons, insights, and reflections embracing the shared human experience, making it an essential read for individuals from all walks of life.** In conclusion, the trilogy’s rich philosophical discussions, relatable character arcs, and insightful exploration of cognitive biases contribute significantly to the fields of psychology and personal development.



Please express any correlation between my list of **strengths**, and a robust list of human **virtues**. Analyze the union of the two for shared characteristics and a deeper meaning.

Certainly! Let’s look at the intersection between the specific strengths from the Clifton StrengthsFinder that you provided (Achiever, Input, Learner, Activator, Belief) and a traditional list of virtues such as wisdom, courage, humanity, justice, temperance, and transcendence.

ACHIEVER

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Achievers have a constant drive for accomplishing tasks. This can correlate with the virtue of courage, which involves persistence and vitality, and justice, where hard work and fairness contribute to the overall good of the community.

INPUT

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom

Explanation: People with the Input strength have a craving to know more, collecting and archiving information. This resonates with wisdom, which is characterized by a pursuit of knowledge and insightful judgment.

LEARNER

Virtue Correlation: Wisdom, Humanity

Explanation: A constant desire to improve and learn aligns with the virtue of wisdom. It may also

align with humanity if the learning is directed towards understanding others and improving social bonds.

ACTIVATOR

Virtue Correlation: Courage, Justice

Explanation: Activators are inclined to take action and want to make things happen. This aligns with courage, as it requires the boldness to initiate, and justice, where action may be directed towards equality and fairness.

BELIEF

Virtue Correlation: Transcendence, Justice

Explanation: The Belief strength is connected to core values and purpose. It aligns with transcendence, where there is a connection to something greater, and justice, where values often include fairness and equality.

Summary of Union (Intersection):

The union between these strengths and virtues reveals a **strong emphasis on wisdom** (through Input and Learner), **courage** (through Achiever and Activator), and **justice** (through Achiever, Activator, and Belief). The values of humanity and transcendence are also present but to a lesser extent.

This analysis suggests that a person with these strengths might be particularly well-suited for roles that require insightful judgment, bold action, and a strong sense of fairness and values. They may excel in leadership roles, educational fields, advocacy, or any area where wisdom, courage, and justice are paramount.

REVIEWS

Sarah Little-Turnbull



You know well of Sarah's talent. She designed the N-95 mask. She conceived of Halmark's tied ribbon bow, and CorningWare. She was a fabulous mentor.

"Daniel is a conceptual thinker who has the ability to implement his ideas with a spectrum of skills. His work represents a unique combination of abilities executed with reliability and great ingenuity. I recommend him very highly."

Graham Kerr



is known for his "Galloping Gourmet" television series and > 29 books. He's a charismatic facilitator of solutions for human indulgence.

"Daniel is continually creative. He has an excellent eye for light, form and texture and an ear for understanding his client's needs. Daniel is an unusual blend of Artist, Technician, Craftsman and Servant who can easily become a partner in your creative process."

Dean Rush



Dean has had distinguished military and business careers, and is the Author of Flying Free. "Daniel Comp is one of the most innovative people I have ever known. I've watched Daniel overcome great obstacles and stick to a vision of making a difference for people. He is personable and doesn't quit until the job is done. I highly recommend Daniel and his wife, Angelina."

2x Awarded by U.S. Small Business Administration, TV/Radio Host/Speaker, a fabulous business partner, wife and my best friend. "I've witnessed Daniel's evolution from a wounded, angry man into a mentally and emotionally mature gentleman. He leads other men with competence and confidence from his own transformation and experience."

Charlie Duke

"As an Astronaut (Apollo 16 Lunar Module Pilot & 10th man on the Moon). I was very familiar with powerful planes and rockets. I've learned to trust my life and business on great tools and competent people. Daniel and Angelina have put together an amazing system for small business that is technically advanced, yet doesn't take a rocket scientist to run it. I highly recommend their services - I didn't settle for anything less!"

Angelina Musik-Comp



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I'm deeply appreciative to those who have invested time, emotion and resources for me to devour. For the encouragement, mental support and feedback, thank you. You have been generous with interest, influence and guidance over decades. For those that journeyed before me, I am indebted to your bravery and demonstration of faith, perseverance and grit.

To all of you, I wish awareness and grace.

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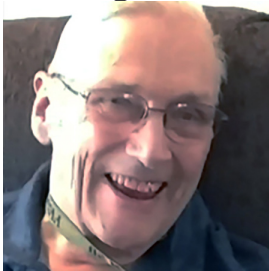


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Josh Cruse
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Garth Hardin



Merlin Berg



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Robert Kane
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Tony Robbins
Tristan Harris
Wayne Dyer
Yuval Harari
Zig Ziggler



MASTER Forrest

To Angelina Musik-Comp:

I am deeply grateful for your stamina, patience, and support as my best friend and business partner. We have traveled the curves together in good cheer. You are amazingly resilient and a joyful character to explore with. I am grateful for your gift of HEALING matching my expression of UNDERSTANDING!

To you, the reader, and participant:

*When I imagined this project, I had a hunch the cost would be years of commitment - but not **five** years. What you might not imagine is that it took me far less time and angst to create the Wellness by Choice syndication, and the Scotomaville syndication of nearly twenty five thousand websites. And now we have AI.*

*I believe “**The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes.**”. Fortunately AI still lacks subjective experiences, emotions, and self-reflective awareness - and thus our superpower of story-telling may yet be an error correcting trim-tab for super intelligent reasoning engines.*

Cheers to YOUR Greatest Expedition!

Daniel Comp
July 4th, 2023

CREDITS & REFERENCES

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